

What You Need

To start recording your TV programmes to your PC (assuming that you don't have a Media Center PC), you'll need to set up a few things:

1. A TV-Tuner Card

You can get one of these for as little as Rs 1,000, but you should preferably invest in a higher-end brand like Pinnacle or Compro, which will cost closer to Rs 2,000. You'll need a free PCI slot on your motherboard to install it.

2. A huge hard disk

Naturally, since you're going to be recording video, you'll need the real estate for it.

3. PVR (Personal Video Recording) Software

This will usually come bundled with the card itself, and Pinnacle's is quite competent on its own. We've talked about more such tools in Chapter 4.

4. A Cable TV Connection

Duh!

Setting It Up

Setting up your equipment is quite easy. Turn off your PC and insert the TV-Tuner card into the free PCI slot. When you start up, Windows will tell you that it has found new hardware, and will ask you for its driver CD. If you didn't get a driver CD, strong words need to be voiced to your dealer. All you need to do now is bring your cable TV connection to the card.